

income taxes, too. Especially painful is the fact Californians pay high state income taxes in addition to federal. Finally, two working parents also meant paying a nanny. Scott explained, “half my day is spent working so I can have somebody else watch my child.”

Rieckens realized they would have to move to a less expensive area if they wanted to save money, which meant nearly anywhere else in the country. Geoarbitrage provided Scott and his wife a path to achieving FI in five to seven years. Even if their projection was “wrong on a pretty decent scale,” they could still be financially independent far faster than they previously imagined.

Geoarbitrage was the focus of the conversation when Mr. Groovy, the writer of *Freedom is Groovy*, was interviewed on the *ChooseFI* podcast. Mr. Groovy and his wife moved from high-cost Long Island, NY to Charlotte, NC. Their story was a stark example of what is possible with geoarbitrage. They decreased their cost of living from about \$7,000/month on Long Island to less than \$1,800/month in North Carolina. They used proceeds from the sale of their Long Island condo to purchase a home for cash in North Carolina, and they still had capital left to add to their investments. One big decision allowed this couple to shed a big mortgage, high property taxes, and other elevated expenses to achieve FI. And they